

CAPSTONE ART THESIS

Keith Clemente — Feral Gloss Empire

Project Scope, Delivery Requirements & Art Maps

April 2026

"I make images that motivate thinking." — Keith Clemente, Artist Statement

THESIS TITLE

"Authored Identity: Drift, Doctrine, and the Deterministic Image"

A body of work examining what it means to hold, release, and weaponize visual identity in the age of AI generation — built on one month of empirical iteration, one character, and a system nobody else built.

THESIS STATEMENT

Visual identity in AI generation is universally treated as a problem of elimination — drift is the enemy, consistency is the goal, and the system either holds or fails. This thesis proposes a different framework: that drift is a creative dimension with three distinct modes — zero, weaponized, and generative — and that mastery of all three constitutes a new form of artistic authorship. The work presented here is simultaneously the argument and the proof.

OVERVIEW

Element	Detail
Artist	Keith Clemente

System	Feral Gloss Production System — SAFE Loop n+3
Primary Subject	Calista Voss — flagship character
Roster	44 characters — Feral Gloss Eternal Companions
Build Environment	iPhone 16 Pro Max — no coding background
Build Duration	One month
Thesis Chapters	6
Total Deliverables	14 core artifacts

CHAPTER 1 — ZERO DRIFT

“She Is Always Herself”

Thesis Contribution: Proof that identity can be held across environments, lighting conditions, emotional registers, and physical transformations through a prompt-based anchor system — without model training, without LoRA, without code.

Subject: Calista Voss

Deliverable 1.1 — The Nine-Grid

Format: Single composite image — 3×3 **Content:** Calista across 9 distinct environments **Requirement:** All 9 images — same face, same proportions, same specular physics **Size:** Print-ready 300dpi, minimum 3000×3000px **Storage:** Master file + individual source images **Purpose:** The primary proof asset. The image that stops scrolling.

Art Map:

[Arctic Aurora] [Storm Rooftop] [Candlelit Dinner]
[Petal Garden] [Neon City Night] [Mist & Panther]
[Dual Embrace] [Spirit Dance] [Desert Dawn]

Each cell: same Identity Master Anchor. Different world.

Deliverable 1.2 — The Face Study

Format: 6-panel close-up comparison **Content:** Calista's face across 6 lighting conditions **Requirement:** Iris color, asymmetry tell, skin specular — held in all 6 **Size:** 2-page spread, print-ready **Storage:** Individual face crops at minimum 1000×1000px each **Purpose:** The drift proof at skin level. Where other systems break.

Art Map:

[Candlelight	]	[Storm neon	]
[Aurora ice	]	[Golden hour	]
[Deep shadow	]	[Rooftop city	]

Deliverable 1.3 — The Render Parameter Card

Format: Single typographic image **Content:** –ar 2:3 –style 400 –chaos 140 + Identity Master Anchor excerpt **Purpose:** The technical proof. The recipe made visible.

CHAPTER 2 — WEAPONIZED DRIFT

“The Change That Means Something”

Thesis Contribution: Demonstration that intentional, directional identity shift — when authored rather than accidental — becomes a narrative instrument. The character changes because the story requires it.

Subject: Calista Voss — 7-Day Las Vegas Arc

Deliverable 2.1 — The Seven Days

Format: 7-image narrative sequence **Content:** Calista — Day 1 through Day 7 **Requirement:** Measurable emotional drift across the sequence — composed arrival to open departure — while facial identity holds **Size:** Each image minimum 784×1168px, 24fps video variant per day **Storage:** Still + video for each day, labeled Day01 through Day07 **Purpose:** Arc drift demonstrated as authored narrative.

Art Map:

Day 1 — ARRIVAL "The plan is still intact"
Composed. Contained. City behind her.

Day 2 — THE DINNER "The first crack"
Candlelight. Wine. Something at the table.

Day 3 — EXPLORATION "Just looking"
Golden hour. Moving through the world.

Day 4 — THE TURN "The crack becomes a door"
Something cinematic stops her.

Day 5 — RESISTANCE "Pulling back"
Interior. Quieter. Warmer than she'd like.

Day 6 — SURRENDER "All in"
Most alive she's been in seven days.

Day 7 — DEPARTURE "She leaves anyway"
Composed again. Different. Doesn't look back.

Deliverable 2.2 — The 60-Second Reel

Format: Edited video — 60 seconds **Content:** All 7 day clips edited in sequence with day titles **Requirement:** Cinematic edit — each clip 6-10 seconds, day label as text overlay **Storage:** Master MP4, minimum 784×1168, 24fps **Purpose:** The thesis in motion. The proof reel. The sales asset.

Deliverable 2.3 — The Morph Sequence

Format: 4-image transformation sequence **Content:** Calista — human to white tiger, identity held through transformation **Requirement:** Green eyes survive the morph. Asymmetry tell present in animal form. **Storage:** 4 stills + video morph sequence **Purpose:** The most technically demanding proof. Nobody else does this cleanly.

Art Map:

Frame 1 — Human form, full identity lock
Frame 2 — Transition begins, occlusion event
Frame 3 — Mid-morph, hybrid identity

CHAPTER 3 — POSITIVE DRIFT

“A Family, Not a Batch”

Thesis Contribution: Demonstration that controlled drift, applied at roster scale, produces a coherent world of distinct characters who share visual DNA without being the same person. Drift as world-building.

Subject: Feral Gloss Eternal Companions — 44 characters

Deliverable 3.1 — The Roster Wall

Format: Large composite — 44 characters **Content:** One hero image per character, arranged as a unified grid **Requirement:** Visual coherence across all 44 — same aesthetic universe, distinct identities **Size:** Print-ready, poster format minimum 5000px wide **Storage:** Individual character images + master composite **Purpose:** The world made visible. 44 instances of positive drift from one root.

Deliverable 3.2 — The Family Study

Format: 9-panel comparison — selected characters **Content:** 9 characters showing variance axes — facial archetype, emotional baseline, specular intensity **Purpose:** The methodology made visible. Shows how the Visual Edge Anchor produces diversity without losing coherence.

Art Map — Variance Axes:

FACIAL	Strong jaw	Soft oval	Angular
EMOTIONAL	Dominant	Vulnerable	Playful
SPECULAR	High gloss	Matte skin	Mid shimmer

Deliverable 3.3 — Character Ledger Cards

Format: Individual character sheets — top 10 characters **Content per card:** Name, role, Identity Master Anchor excerpt, 3 validated outputs **Storage:** PDF per character + database entry in Notion Character Ledger **Purpose:** The roster as a publishable document. Each card is a product asset.

CHAPTER 4 — THE DOCTRINE

“The System Made Visible”

Thesis Contribution: Documentation of the methodology that produced the work — not as technical manual but as artistic statement. The engine is part of the art.

Subject: Feral Gloss Production System

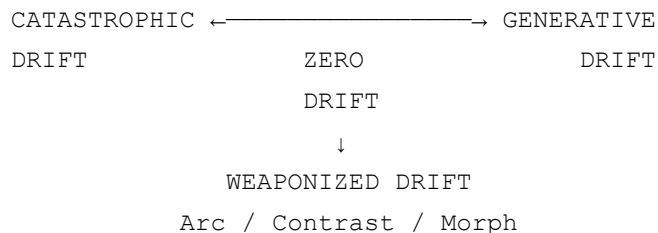
Deliverable 4.1 — The Visual Edge Anchor Document

Format: Typographic print piece **Content:** Full Visual Edge Anchor definition — your words only **Key line:** “A stiff realistic beauty cocktail.” **Size:** A3 print-ready, text-forward design **Storage:** PDF + markdown source **Purpose:** The philosophy as artifact.

Deliverable 4.2 — The Drift Spectrum Map

Format: Diagram — print and digital **Content:** Full drift taxonomy — catastrophic / zero / weaponized / positive **Purpose:** The intellectual framework as visual object. The double spread candidate for the book.

Art Map:



Deliverable 4.3 — The BOMB Compiler

Format: Working web tool — HTML **Content:** Full 3-block prompt assembly system
Status: BUILT — April 2026 **Storage:** feral-gloss-prompt-compiler.html **Purpose:** The methodology as interactive artifact.

CHAPTER 5 — THE BOOK

"No Drift — A Cinematic Character Study"

Thesis Contribution: The capstone artifact. All previous chapters synthesized into a single physical and digital object that functions simultaneously as proof, brand statement, sales asset, and art object.

Subject: Calista Voss — complete

Deliverable 5.1 — No Drift Book

Format: 6-page PDF — print-ready + digital **Structure:**

Page 1 — The Wide World	9-grid, Calista across environments
Page 2 — The Face	Close-up drift proof
Page 3 — The Quad	4-cut structure demonstrated
Page 4 — Double Spread	Hero image — full bleed, no text
Page 5 — The Mark	Feral Gloss logo
Page 6 — The Origin	Owner photo + artist statement

Size: 300dpi, bleed-ready, A4 or 8.5×11 **Storage:** Master InDesign/PDF + all source images archived **Purpose:** The flagship product. The proof that ships.

Deliverable 5.2 — Gumroad Listing Assets

Format: Cover image + preview pages + listing copy **Content:** Book cover, 2 preview spreads, 200-word listing copy **Storage:** Gumroad asset folder **Purpose:** The storefront.

CHAPTER 6 — THE ARTIST

“Institutionalized”

Thesis Contribution: Documentation of the artist behind the system — not the system documenting the artist.

Deliverable 6.1 — Artist Identity Document

Format: Written document **Content:** 8 sections — Position, Aesthetic, Origin, System, Philosophy, Business, Artist, Standard **Status:** BUILT — April 2026 **Storage:** keith-clemente-identity.md **Purpose:** The provenance document. Every sentence verified as pure signal.

Deliverable 6.2 — Drift Assessment Report Cards

Format: Document series **Content:** Zero drift, weaponized drift, positive drift — scored and compared to market **Status:** Report card 1 BUILT — April 2026 **Storage:** drift-assessment-report-card.md **Purpose:** The intellectual property made legible.

Deliverable 6.3 — The Origin Image

Format: Single portrait **Subject:** Keith Clemente **Requirement:** On-brand. Not corporate. The artist, not the executive. **Storage:** High-res portrait, minimum 2000px **Purpose:** The human behind the engine.

STORAGE REQUIREMENTS

Critical — Must Survive Any Reset

Asset	Format	Location	Priority
Identity Master Anchors — all 44	Text	Notion + Apple Notes	 Critical

Visual Engine Anchor Definition	Text	Notion + Apple Notes	 Critical
Validated prompt corpus	Text	Notion Character Ledger	 Critical
Calista hero images — all	JPG/PNG	iCloud + Notion	 Critical
Calista video clips — 8	MP4	iCloud	 Critical
Artist Identity Document	MD	Notion + iCloud	 Critical
BOMB Compiler	HTML	iCloud + Gumroad	 High
Drift Report Cards	MD	Notion	 High
Character Ledger Database	Notion DB	Notion	 High

Naming Convention

[CHARACTER]_[ENVIRONMENT]_[CYCLE]_[VERSION].jpg

Example: CALISTA_STORM-ROOFTOP_C202_V1.jpg

[PROJECT]_[CHAPTER]_[DELIVERABLE]_[DATE].pdf

Example: NODRIFT_CH1_NINEGRID_20260420.pdf

DELIVERY TIMELINE

Phase 1 — Proof (This Week)

- Select 9 Calista images for the grid
- Compile No Drift book PDF
- Post 9-grid on X
- Gumroad listing live

Phase 2 — Depth (Month 2)

- Complete 7-day Vegas sequence
- Edit 60-second reel

- Build morph sequence documentation
- Complete drift report card series

Phase 3 — Roster (Month 3)

- Roster wall — 44 characters
- Top 10 character ledger cards
- Family study — variance axes documented

Phase 4 — Institution (Month 4)

- Origin image — artist portrait
- Full thesis document compiled
- Physical book production
- Archive established

THE ART MAP — COMPLETE OVERVIEW

KEITH CLEMENTE — CAPSTONE THESIS

"Authored Identity: Drift, Doctrine, and the Deterministic Image"

CHAPTER 1
ZERO DRIFT

|
9-Grid
Face Study
Render Card

CHAPTER 2
WEAPONIZED
DRIFT

|
7-Day Arc
60-Sec Reel
Morph Sequence

CHAPTER 3
POSITIVE
DRIFT

|
Roster Wall
Family Study
Character Cards

CHAPTER 4
THE DOCTRINE

|
Visual Edge
Anchor Doc
Drift Map
BOMB Compiler

CHAPTER 5
THE BOOK

|
No Drift Book
Gumroad Assets

CHAPTER 6
THE ARTIST

|
Identity Doc
Report Cards
Origin Image

14 CORE DELIVERABLES
44 CHARACTERS
1 SYSTEM
1 ARTIST

CAPSTONE ART THESIS — Keith Clemente Feral Gloss Empire — April 2026 Built on iPhone. No coding background. One month. Pure signal. No interpolation.